

Instant — Unit Economics

The destination rail — low, but not free

FULLY-LOADED COST PER TRANSACTION

\$0.770

This is the cost you migrate TO

Cost component	Detail	Amount	% of total
1. Network fee		\$0.045	5.8%
2. Processing / operations		\$0.100	13.0%
3. Failure & exception	0.5% return × \$5.00/item	\$0.025	3.2%
4. Fraud loss (expected)		\$0.250	32.5%
5. Fraud prevention / screening		\$0.150	19.5%
6. Compliance (AML / sanctions)		\$0.100	13.0%
7. Reconciliation		\$0.050	6.5%
8. Liquidity / prefunding		\$0.050	6.5%
TOTAL		\$0.770	100.0%

Cost composition (share of the fully-loaded cost)



What this means: This is the rail you migrate **to**. It is cheap, but **not free**: real-time fraud screening, irrevocable-payment (APP scam) loss risk, and 24/7 prefunding push it to **\$0.77/txn** — still a fraction of checks (\$2.98) and wires (\$18.57).

Sources: Network fees — Fed / Nacha / The Clearing House pricing. Failure rates — Nacha return thresholds (~1.5% typical); failed-payment cost ~\$12.10 (LexisNexis). Fraud — AFP Payments Fraud Survey; 2024 losses check ~\$24B, ACH ~\$11B, APP ~\$12.5B. Compliance — FFIEC / BSA-AML. Liquidity — RTP prefunded joint account (frbservices.org). All figures are conservative public-benchmark midpoints, to be calibrated with Payfinia production data. See Deliverable 1.